

My daughter, the tech bros and algorithms don't get to decide how I parent. I do!

BRYONY GORDON

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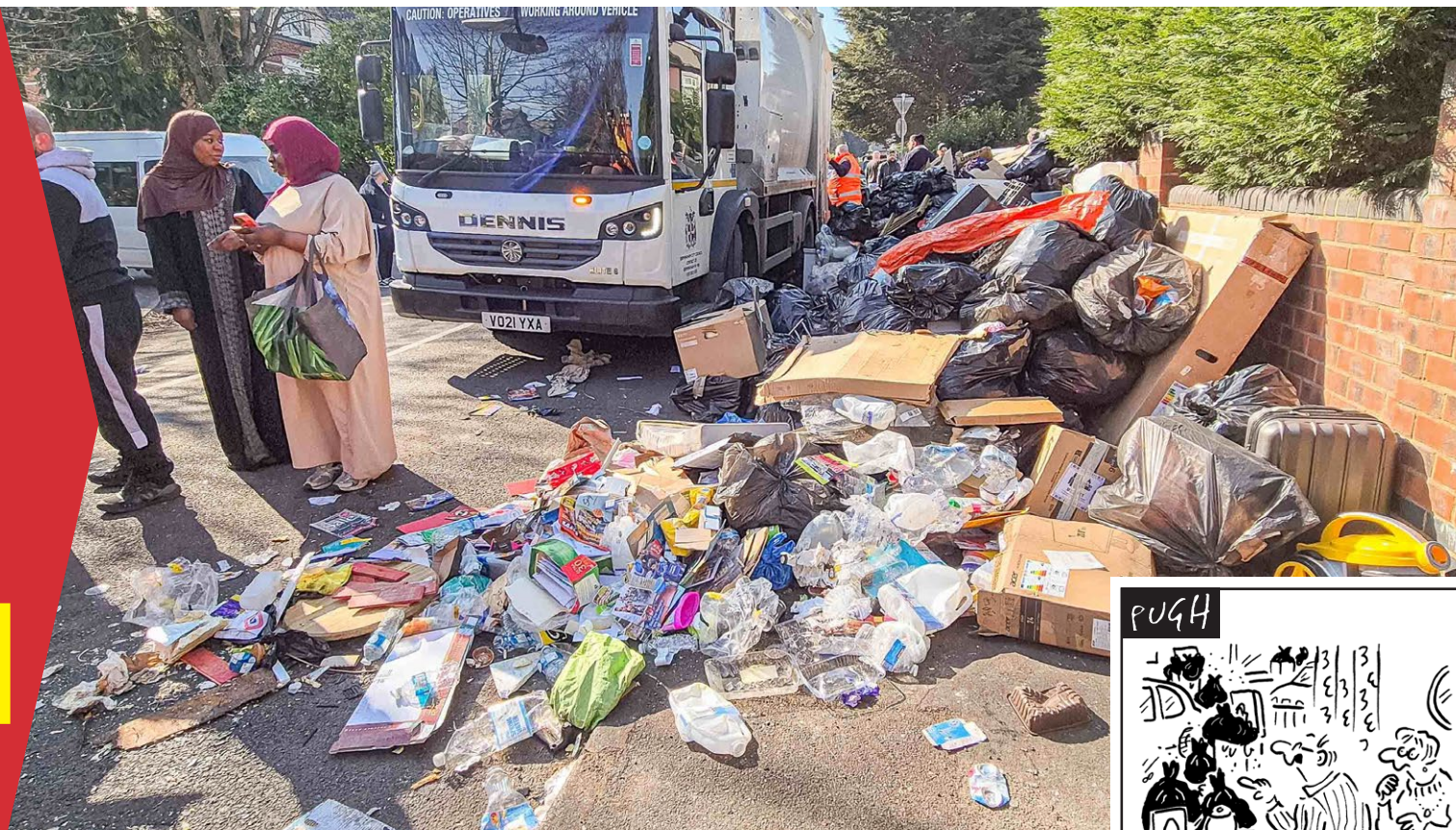
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COUNCIL TAX SOARS TO A RECORD HIGH

BUT THE SERVICE YOU GET IS STILL RUBBISH

Bin there, not done that:
The scene in Birmingham



STRUGGLING families will pay record levels of council tax this year after millions were hit with inflation-busting bills.

Homes across England face pay-

By **Martin Beckford** Policy Editor

ing an average of £2,280 after almost all town halls raised the tax by the maximum 5 per cent allowed, official figures confirmed yesterday.

It means rates for a standard Band D property have soared by 20 per cent in

just five years. And it comes as residents in Birmingham – where bills are up 17.5 per cent in two years – chased bin lorries down the street after a week-long strike left piles of rubbish sacks standing waist high, with rats running rampant.

Hundreds of thousands of households

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